

MSIPS gets extended

The benefits from the Modified Special Incentive Package Scheme (MSIPS) may get extended till 2020. It aims at boosting electronic manufacturing in the country. The extension would now include almost the complete range of segment for getting the incentive benefits.

A cabinet note was drafted by Ministry of Communications and IT for the approval of amendments in MSIPS. Only those firms that will apply for investment under the scheme by July 2015 would get its benefits.

An official said that the cabinet note has been prepared, keeping in mind the net-zero import of electronics items target. MSIPS was first approved in 2012, mainly to provide reimbursement for taxes and duties to various capital-intensive and hi-tech products like electronics chip manufacturing.

The scheme provides 20 per cent on capital investment made in SEZs and 25 per cent on capital investment made in non-SEZs. The proposal will now also involve LEDs, solar cells, nano-electronic components, smart cards and others for reimbursement of central taxes.

The government is also planning to reduce minimum investment limit by up to 90 per cent. According to estimates, Indian electronics market may reach \$400 billion by 2020 or 2022, and if corrective measures for reduction of imports are not taken then the imports might get beyond \$300 billion.

PM eases registration process in MSME sector

The micro, small and medium enterprise sector in India has been given special assurance by prime minister Narendra Modi that the registration process in the sector will be eased.

He addressed the nation on the occasion of Vijaya Dashami and shared his 'Mann Ki Baat' initiative. Modi said in his speech, "I have received various sug-

ECIL's CMD selected as 'Electronics Man of the Year'

P. Sudhakar, chairman and managing director, Electronics Corporation of India Limited, Hyderabad, has been selected as 'Electronics Man of the Year' by ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India.

Tapan Ray is new additional secretary, DeitY

Tapan Ray has been appointed as additional secretary for the Department of Electronics and Information Technology, Ministry of Communications and Information Technology.

Arindam Majumdar joins Fluke India

Arindam Majumdar has been appointed as MD and country head of Fluke, India, from October 2014, succeeding Joey Joseph. Arindam is a talented and versatile leader, with a wealth of experience in the industrial sector. He has earlier worked at GE and Alstom.

Mike McMullen appointed CEO of Agilent Technologies

Mike McMullen has been appointed the new CEO of Agilent Technologies. He will succeed William (Bill) Sullivan, who will remain as an advisor till the end of the company's fiscal year, i.e., October 31, 2015, which is when he will retire.

gestions from people regarding the problems they are facing in the registration of small-scale industries. We are working on making the registration process simpler." Some suggestions that were received were: the need to initiate skill development at an early age, drafting of special programmes to encourage specially-abled children and registration process in small-scale industries to be simpler.

Modi promised that his 'Mann Ki Baat' will be a regular address—twice a month, every Sunday.

On Gandhi Jayanti, October 2, Modi also launched 'Clean India' campaign and urged the entire country to become a part of it. On Vijaya Dashami, he added, "This Vijaya Dashami, let us win over dirtiness around us," referring to the Clean India campaign.

MP an ideal state for defence and electronics industry

During the Global Investors Summit at Indore, the electronic system design and management (ESDM) experts stated that Madhya Pradesh is an ideal state for the establishment of defence industry and electronic products of other sectors.

A.S. Pillai, founder of Brahmos Missile, stated that conducive situations

in Madhya Pradesh are perfect for the development of defence electronics in the state. He talked about the growing importance of electronics and the Defence Electronics Research Development Organisation (DRDO), which will be situated in Gwalior. While throwing some light on the Brahmos and AGNI missile programmes, he mentioned the lack of electronics item manufactures in Madhya Pradesh and thereby advised entrepreneurs to invest in the same.

On the subject, Union joint secretary electronics, Dr Ajay Kumar, talked about the facilities and concessions being provided to the electronics industry. He said that Madhya Pradesh will play a major role in achieving the net target of zero imports till 2020. He talked about the abundance of human resource in the state, talented youth and the electronics skill-development programme started for them.

Phablets hindering the growth of India tablet PC market

Rising demand for mobility across the consumer electronics sector, primarily in the education and private enterprises, has fuelled the growth of the tablet PC market in India. Affordable prices

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